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HAVING AUTHORED 17 BOOKS, NATARAJAN SAYS WRITING HELPS HIM CONTINUE LEARNING WHILE SHARING LEADERSHIP INSIGHTS

But the transition quickly opened new avenues of contribution. Due to his professional achievements, he was able to find opportunities through advisory roles as well as board positions, which helped him keep his sense of self-worth intact.

Since stepping away from executive leadership, Natarajan has remained active across business, entrepreneurship, governance, and social impact, chairing organisations, including GTT Data Solutions, Honeywell Automation India, and Lighthouse Communities Foundation, while serving on multiple corporate and social sector boards.

“Today, I balance my time between scaling social enterprises, investing in young companies, serving on boards, writing, public speaking, and travelling,” he says.

Having authored 17 books, Natarajan says writing helps him continue learning while sharing leadership insights.

“I started travelling more, both for leisure and family reasons, and started writing more,” he says. “That enables me to keep learning too.”

At the core of this phase, however, lies a simpler definition of purpose. “Purpose is making a difference in whatever activity I invest my time,” he says. “And that happens through boards, investing, and social work.”

‘RELEVANCE DOES NOT END WITH DESIGNATION’

Ganesh Natarajan

► **FOR NATARAJAN**, life after corporate leadership evolved not into retirement, but into a portfolio spanning boards, entrepreneurship, social impact, writing, and mentoring. “Initially, there was a worry that I would miss my quarterly appearances on news channels and the frequent interactions with press and analysts,” says Natarajan. “I was indeed worried about a loss of identity.”

**Former MD & CEO of Bharti Airtel,
Manoj Kohli’s Best Management Advice Pg 82**